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8 May 2025

Todd Lyons, Acting Director
U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement
500 12th St SW
Washington, DC 20536

U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement
Buffalo Field Office
250 Delaware Avenue, Floor 7
Buffalo, NY 14202
Buffalo.Outreach@ice.dhs.gov

We write to vigorously protest the detention and threatened deportation of 14 farm workers involved in a union organizing drive at Lynn-Ette & Sons Farms in Kent, New York. We demand the immediate release of these workers and that all deportation proceedings be terminated.

For years, the United Farm Workers (UFW) has been fighting to organize farm workers at Lynn-Ette. The detained workers are originally from Mexico and Guatemala and work year-round at Lynn-Ette. On 2 May, they were being bused to work at the farm when ICE agents in unmarked cars pulled the bus over. The agents, using a list of names, targeted specific workers for detention and deportation, including several who have been active in the UFW union drive.

This blatant act of government union-busting is an attack on the entire workers movement. We demand: Release the detained farm workers! Hands off the United Farm Workers! No deportations!

Sincerely,

Kevin E. Gilroy

Kevin Gilroy
For the Partisan Defense Committee

The PDC is a class-struggle, non-sectarian legal and social defense organization which champions cases and causes in the interest of the whole of the working people. This purpose is in accordance with the political views of the Spartacist League.

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